

Panel 3 Layout Blueprint & Wording

[Board 3 Header]

- **Font:** 96pt, Bold, Centered
 - **Text:** THE SIEVE OF HISTORY: HOW THE CANON WAS SEALED
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[Section A: The Three-Fold Test]

- *Layout:* Left Side (Top to Bottom). This section sits next to your central infographic.
 - **Subheader (48pt): How a Book Passed the Filter**
 - **Body Text (24pt):**

The early councils did not "choose" or "invent" the books of the Bible. Instead, they acted like a defensive jury, using three strict tests to recognize the books that had already guided the global community for centuries.
 - **Bullet Points (24pt):**
 - **Apostolicity:** Did the text come directly from an eyewitness Apostle or their immediate associate?
 - **Orthodoxy:** Did the teaching align perfectly with the older scriptures and the foundational rule of faith?
 - **Catholicity:** Was the book being used universally by isolated churches across the entire known world?
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[Section B: The Sieve Infographic Area]

- *Layout:* Top Right. Place your clean, geometric **Funnel/Sieve Infographic** right here.
- **Graphic Concept:**
 - Draw a large funnel shape.
 - At the top, label a cloud of floating book names like *Gospel of Thomas*, *1 Enoch*, *Shepherd of Hermas*, alongside *Gospel of John* and *Romans*.
 - Show three horizontal filter lines cutting through the funnel, labeled **Apostolicity**, **Orthodoxy**, and **Catholicity**.

- At the bottom spout of the funnel, show a neat stack of books cleanly emerging, labeled **The 66 Canonical Books**.
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[Section C: The Borderline Books]

- *Layout:* Bottom Right (directly beneath the infographic).
 - **Subheader (48pt): Rejected vs. Retained**
 - **Body Text (24pt):**

The defensive system was designed to protect the baseline truth. Looking at what was excluded reveals the strict integrity of the filter.
 - **Bullet Points (24pt):**
 - **The Excluded:** Books like *1 Enoch* or *The Gospel of Thomas* failed because they lied about their true author or contained wild, contradictory theology.
 - **The Debated:** Books like *Esther*, *Hebrews*, and *Revelation* were intensely debated but ultimately made the cut because their total orthodoxy and global usage were verified.
 - **The Result:** The canon was permanently closed at the Council of Carthage in 397 CE, securing a stable, trustworthy foundation for future generations.
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Layout Coordination

This panel relies heavily on the clean geometric divide between the text on the left and the graphic elements on the right. Keep the funnel graphic bold and colorful (using contrasting lines for the filters) so it catches the eye from across the room.

We have reached the final phase! If you are ready, I can map out the final layout and text blueprint for **Panel 4: Passing the Torch (The Living Word)**, which will frame how you present and highlight your **Child's Version of the Torah** on its reading ledge. Let me know if you would like to complete the series.